Teen Tennis Player Scores a Surprise First Win

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British teenager Mika Stojsavljevic has won her first WTA Tour main-draw match and she only found out she was playing one hour before it started!

The 17-year-old had lost in **qualifying** for the Hong Kong Open. But another player pulled out, so Stojsavljevic got a second chance as a "**lucky loser**."

Her **opponent** was Sofia Kenin, a former Australian Open champion ranked 224 places above her. Stojsavljevic won the match 6-3, 4-6, 6-4.

"I only knew an hour before I was going to be playing. I kind of just went out and swung today," she said. "I believed in myself and it worked out."

Stojsavljevic started playing tennis at age seven in London. In 2024, she won the US Open **junior** title the first Briton in 15 years to do it.

Next, she plays world number 67 Zeynep Sonmez in the second round.

Word Treasure

lucky loser -- A player who lost in qualifying but still gets a place in the main draw when another player pulls out.

qualifying -- Early matches that players must win to earn a place in the main part of a tournament.

opponent -- The person or team you are playing against in a game or contest.

junior -- For young players; a junior title is a championship for teenagers.

Background you need

Tennis players are ranked in order, so a low-ranked player beating a champion is a big upset.

A 'lucky loser' is a player who lost but still gets a place when someone else drops out.

Big wins like this can start a young player's career.

Break it down

WHO: Mika Stojsavljevic, a 17-year-old British tennis player
WHAT: She won her first WTA Tour main-draw match against a former champion
WHERE: At the Hong Kong Open
WHY: Another player pulled out, so she got a second chance as a lucky loser -- and she believed in herself

Why it matters

Mika's win shows that being ready when a surprise chance comes -- and believing in yourself -- can change everything, even at 17.

Test what you remember

1. How did Mika get into the main draw?

- (A) By being the champion
- (B) By paying for a place
- (C) As a lucky loser after another player pulled out
- (D) By winning qualifying

2. When did she find out she was playing?

- (A) One week before
- (B) One hour before the match
- (C) She never found out
- (D) After the match

3. Who did she beat?

- (A) Her brother
- (B) Nobody yet
- (C) Sofia Kenin
- (D) Zeynep Sonmez

4. What is special about Kenin?

- (A) She is Mika's coach
- (B) She is a former Australian Open champion
- (C) She never won a match
- (D) She is 17 too

5. How old is Mika?

- (A) 30
- (B) 12
- (C) 27
- (D) 17

6. What did Mika win in 2024?

- (A) A singing contest
- (B) An Olympic medal
- (C) The US Open junior title
- (D) The Hong Kong Open

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: C 4: B 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Mika Stojsavljevic: Said she just went out and swung, and believed in herself.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):